



HEARING

“Canaphone”

A piece of string threaded through two empty cans works kind of like a telephone. If you speak into one can, the vibrations travel along the string to the other can—allowing your voice to be heard.

Hearing is one of your five senses. Your ears are important and delicate: they pick up sounds and send messages to your brain. Sounds travel through the air in waves. Your outer ears, the shell-shaped flaps on the side of your head, catch sound waves and funnel them inside. These waves hit the eardrum and make it vibrate. The middle ear and the inner ear change the vibrations into electrical signals, which are sorted out and recognized by your brain.



Talking in signs

If deaf people have never heard speech, they may not have learned to talk. To help them to communicate, many learn a special language called signing. There are many different forms of sign language used in different countries and regions. Deaf people also learn to spell using their hands, and to read lips by watching the shape of people’s mouths as they speak.



Kneel



Hunger



Hope

The outer ear collects the sounds and funnels them along the ear canal.

Crash!

The loudness of sound is measured in decibels. Quiet whispering is less than 25 decibels, the clash of cymbals about 90, and a jet plane taking off can measure more than 130 decibels. Noises over 120 decibels can cause pain and may damage your ears.

